

THE RECIPE COLLECTION

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TOASTY CHEESE BAKE

MAIN DISHES 1



A vibrant, garlicky shrimp pasta tossed with al dente spaghetti, a generous drizzle of good olive oil, and finished with a bright squeeze of fresh lemon for a dish that tastes like a summer evening in coastal Italy.

MAKES 4 SERVINGS · PREP 15 MIN · COOK 20 MIN

INGREDIENTS

- 400 g spaghetti
- 450 g large raw shrimp, peeled and deveined
- 4 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 6 cloves garlic, thinly sliced
- 1/2 tsp red chili flakes
- 120 ml dry white wine
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter
- zest of 1 lemon
- 3 tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 3 tbsp fresh flat-leaf parsley, finely chopped
- 80 g freshly grated Parmigiano-Reggiano
- 40 g breadcrumbs, toasted
- 1 tsp fine sea salt, plus more for pasta water
- 1/2 tsp freshly ground black pepper

DIRECTIONS

Salt and boil the pasta. Bring a large pot of water to a rolling boil and salt it generously — it should taste like the sea. Cook the spaghetti according to package directions until just al dente, then reserve 240 ml of pasta cooking water before draining.

Toast the breadcrumbs. While the pasta cooks, heat 1 tbsp of the olive oil in a small skillet over medium heat. Add the breadcrumbs and toast, stirring frequently, for 2–3 minutes until golden and crisp, then transfer to a small bowl and set aside.

Sauté the garlic. In a large, wide skillet heat the remaining 3 tbsp olive oil over medium heat. Add the sliced garlic and chili flakes and cook, stirring, for about 90 seconds until the garlic turns pale gold and fragrant — do not let it brown.

Cook the shrimp. Season the shrimp with the salt and pepper and add them to the skillet in a single layer. Cook for 1–2 minutes per side until just pink and opaque, then remove them to a plate and set aside.

Deglaze and build the sauce. Pour the white wine into the skillet and let it simmer for 2 minutes, scraping up any golden bits from the bottom. Add the butter and stir until melted, then pour in 120 ml of the reserved pasta water and bring to a gentle simmer.

Toss everything together. Add the drained spaghetti to the skillet and toss vigorously over medium heat for 1–2 minutes, adding more pasta water a splash at a time until the sauce clings silkily to every strand. Return the shrimp to the pan along with the lemon zest, lemon juice, and parsley and toss once more.

Finish and serve. Divide the pasta among four warm bowls or plates. Top each portion generously with the grated Parmigiano-Reggiano and a shower of the toasted breadcrumbs for that signature toasty finish. Serve immediately.



For an even deeper flavor, use shell-on shrimp and make a quick stock by simmering the shells in water for 10 minutes, then use that in place of the pasta water in the sauce. Don't skip the toasted breadcrumbs — they are the 'toasty' soul of this dish and add essential texture against the silky pasta. If you prefer to skip wine, substitute with an equal amount of low-sodium chicken broth plus an extra squeeze of lemon. This dish waits for no one — have everyone seated before you start tossing, as it is best eaten the moment it hits the table.